



SAFETY TOOLBOX TALK

Ref:	044	Author:	D Bibby	Date:	07.02.2024
Topic:	MANUAL HANDLING				

This briefing is not intended to tell you how to do your jobs, it is designed to help keep you safe. We want everybody to be able to return home safely to their family and friends at the end of each day.

In the UK, 54 million working days are lost each year because of pain, strain and injuries to the back. Back strains are a common injury too. These can be caused by using poor techniques to move materials such as twisting and turning while lifting, carrying or digging.

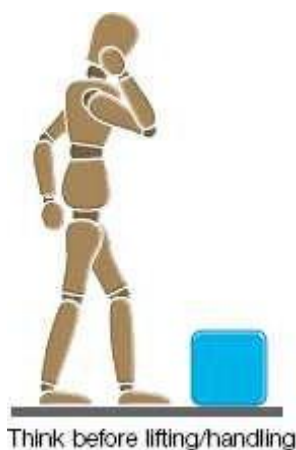
Stop and think before lifting/handling.

Notify your Manager of any medical condition that could affect your ability to handle loads. illness, pregnancy or existing injury.

Do Not

Attempt to lift more than you can easily manage. Do not continue the task if you feel pain/discomfort. Tell your Manager.

How to lift safely



Plan the lift.

- Gently rock the load to test the weight and its distribution.
- Check whether you need to move it at all, use lifting aids if they are available.
- Reduce the weight of the load if possible.
- Where is the load going?
- Do you need help?
- Are there obstructions in the way?
- Is there somewhere to set it down?
- Are you wearing the correct personal protective equipment (PPE)?



Adopt a stable position.

- Feet should be apart with one leg slightly forward to maintain balance (alongside the load if it is on the ground).
- Be prepared to move your feet during the lift to maintain stability.



Bend your knees not your back.

- Keep your back straight.
- Grip the load with your palms, rather than just your fingers. Keep your arms close to your body to help support the load.

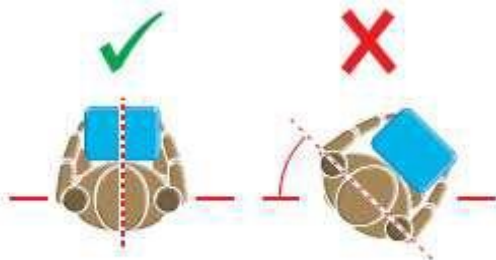
Lifting Manoeuvre

- Lift smoothly avoiding jerking movements.
- Bend your knees.
- Lift your head first – the back then straightens automatically.
- Use your leg muscles to lift the load – not your back.
- If you feel excessive strain, slowly lower the load and seek help.



Keep the load close to the waist.

- Keep the heaviest side of the load next to the body.
- If a close approach to the load is not possible, try to slide it towards the body before attempting to lift it.



Avoid twisting the back or leaning sideways, especially while the back is bent

Avoid twisting the back or leaning sideways.

- Shoulders should be kept level and facing the same direction as the hips.
- Turning by moving the feet is better than twisting and lifting at the same time.

Discussion Points

Have you thought about the risks involved in lifting an object and can it be lifted another way?

Have you ever thought I picked that up wrong. By getting a twinge in your back after picking something up at home or work?

Just to reiterate is everyone happy the correct lifting techniques?